

Linguistic Differences between Languages

- Syntactic variation between **SVO** (e.g. English), **SOV** (e.g. Hindi), and **VSO** (e.g. Arabic) languages
 - SVO languages tend to use prepositions
 - SOV languages tend to use postpositions
- **Pro-drop** languages regularly omit subjects that must be inferred when translated to other languages
 - I don't know. Did you like it? 知らない。気に入った？
Shiranai. Ki ni itta?
 know-NEGATIVE. like-PAST?
 - הלכתי הביתה I went home

Reminder: “Word” Order Differences

- Compare English with Japanese glosses:

“IBM bought Lotus”



“IBM Lotus bought”

“Sources said that IBM bought Lotus yesterday”

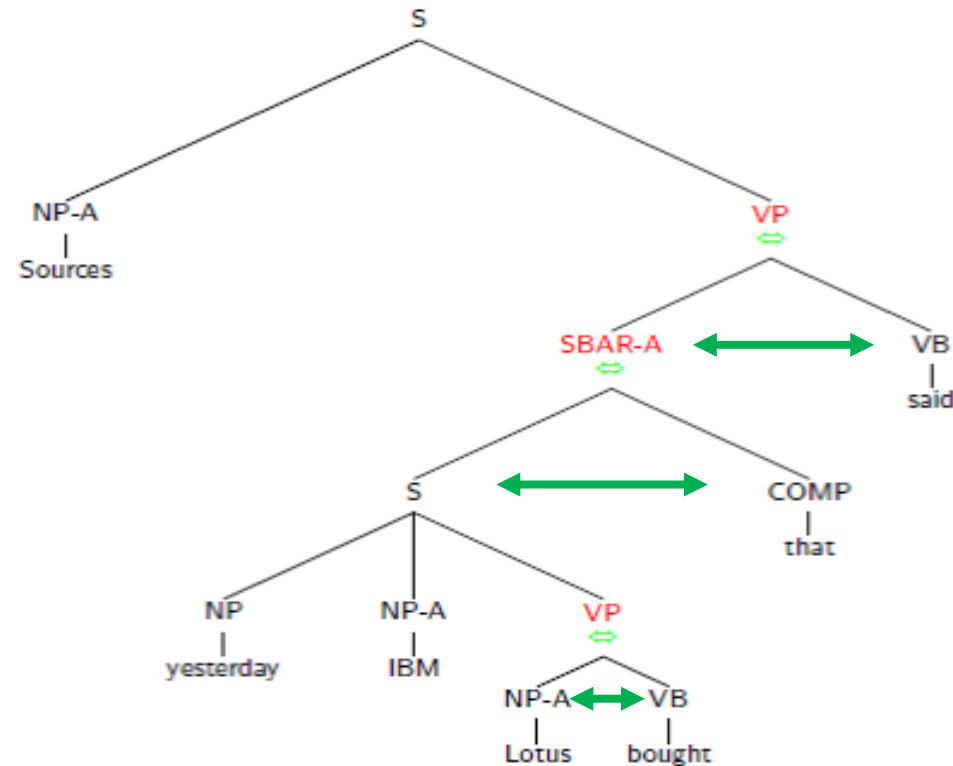


“Sources yesterday IBM Lotus bought that said”

- It is difficult to phrase the possible permutations in terms of words, easier in terms of phrases

Word Order Differences

- This can be seen by comparing English and Japanese Constituency Structures:



Linguistic Divergences

- Changes between some languages can be much more substantial

- Linguistic divergences (which are not word order differences):

- “I like him” ↔ “הוא מוצא חן בעיניי”
- “to be cold” ↔ “avoir froid” (lit. “to have cold”)

